

What the model’s atoms say about your taste

A reading of your listening, inferred from the concepts the next-track model learned to represent. Exploratory — read it as “what the model’s memory is organized around,” not a verdict.

How this reading is made (in plain terms)

The model that guesses your next song builds up a little **memory** as it listens to a session. On its own that memory is a tangle — thousands of numbers, none of them meaning any one thing. So we do two things:

1. **Pop the memory open and force it to be tidy.** We train a small helper (a “sparse dictionary”) that has to re-describe the model’s memory using only a handful of internal **switches** at a time. Forced to be economical, each switch stops being a vague blur and starts standing for *one recognizable thing*.
2. **Read the switches back.** We then check what each switch actually reacts to, and almost every one lines up with a specific **artist** or **genre** — the thing whose songs it best predicts coming next.

So the lists below are, quite literally, **the things the model found most worth keeping a dedicated switch for** in order to predict what you play next. And when the model spends *several* switches on one artist, that artist isn’t just frequent — it shapes your sessions in several distinct ways. No songs are stored; it’s the patterns.

Two honest caveats: the model’s fingerprint includes the **artist name**, so the switches skew artist-shaped; and these are the **frequent, predictive** concepts, not your whole taste — a one-off favourite won’t earn a switch. It’s a map of what dominates your listening, not a judgement of it.

(Method, for the curious: a top-k sparse autoencoder over the next-track GRU’s hidden state, k=32 active atoms — see [sae-interpretability-note.pdf](#). The 80 strongest atoms of that run are what’s summarized here.)

The map of your taste

1. **A deep, producer-led electronic core — by far the largest region.** The model spends most of its switches here, and they span the whole texture range rather than one sub-genre:

- **UK garage / house:** Joy Orbison (8 switches — tied for the most of any artist), Jamie xx, DJ Koze, Four Tet, Underworld
- **Sampledelic / plunderphonic:** The Avalanches (6 switches)
- **Trip-hop / downtempo / balearic:** Massive Attack, Thievery Corporation, Air, Tosca
- **Melodic / leftfield dance:** Caribou and its house alias Daphni (8 switches between them)
- **IDM / electronic pioneers:** Aphex Twin, Kraftwerk — plus dedicated **minimal techno** switches

This is the spine of your listening: not “EDM,” but a *crate-digger’s* electronic palette — warm, melodic, producer-driven (a Warp / Ninja Tune / XL / Border Community lineage).

2. **An atmospheric indie / dream-pop axis.** The other big pole is guitar-led and textural: **DIIV** (7 switches), **The xx**, and a strong run of dedicated **indie rock** switches (6). Dreamy and reverb-soaked rather than loud.

3. A strong, personal Argentine thread. Distinct from both, and clearly a big part of *your* listening specifically: **Laika Perra Rusa** earns the **most switches of any artist (8)**. This local scene isn't incidental — it's one of the model's best-represented regions.

4. Art-rock as the bridge, and one heavier outlier. **Radiohead** (plus **album rock** switches) and **Gorillaz** sit between the electronic and indie poles — art-rock / genre-blurring connective tissue. And one clearly distinct strand: **Rammstein** (3 switches) — an industrial-metal pocket that stands apart from everything else, which is exactly why the model gives it its own switches.

Your anchors

The artists the model spends the **most** capacity on — several distinct switches each — are your true anchors: the sounds that recur across many sessions and in more than one mode.

Laika Perra Rusa and **Joy Orbison** (8 switches each), **DIIV** (7), **The Avalanches** (6), then **Massive Attack**, **Daphni**, **Caribou**, **Air**, **Thievery Corporation** (4 each), **DJ Koze**, **Rammstein** (3).

That an artist gets many switches means they occupy several sub-modes in your listening — depth, not just play-count.

In one line

Your taste, as the model sees it, is a **melodic, producer-led electronic core** (UK garage / house → downtempo → IDM) woven together with **atmospheric indie / dream-pop**, carrying a strong, personal **Argentine indie-rock** thread, bridged by **Radiohead / Gorillaz art-rock** — with a distinct **Rammstein industrial-metal** pocket off to one side. It's anchored by a handful of artists (Laika Perra Rusa, Joy Orbison, DIIV, The Avalanches) deep enough to occupy several of the model's dimensions at once.